

MSP vendor evaluation scorecard

For New Jersey small and midsized businesses | One copy per vendor | October 6, 2026

Vendor: _____ Reviewer: _____

Date: _____ Need: general IT / security / both

Score each criterion: 0 = missing or unclear; 1 = explained, but unverified or incomplete; 2 = written and supported by relevant evidence. Mark an unresolved exception even if other evidence is strong.

Criterion	Evidence to request	0 / 1 / 2
Scope and ownership	Written coverage, exclusions, and responsibility map.	_____
Support and escalation	Support hours, onsite terms, escalation contacts, response vs. resolution.	_____
Security operations	Named monitoring team, covered systems, containment authority and hours.	_____
Provider access	Named admin accounts, MFA, least privilege, logging, and access removal.	_____
Backup and recovery	Covered data, retention, restore owner, and a dated restore test.	_____
Evidence and reporting	Redacted sample report; current evidence, exceptions, and review owner.	_____
Commercial terms	Onboarding, minimums, extras, adjustments, renewal notice, and exit costs.	_____
Industry and working fit	Relevant references where available; coordination with your IT owner.	_____

Total: ____ / 16. This is a comparison aid, not a certification. Do not select a vendor on the total alone. Resolve critical gaps in access, response ownership, coverage, or contract scope first.

Unresolved gaps: _____

Next decision / owner / date: _____

Evidence rule: Keep dated records tied to the systems in scope. Have the technical owner verify facts and an authorized business signer approve customer or insurer answers.

Companion guide: helmsecured.com/resources/managed-service-providers-new-jersey/

Keep completed copies in your approved internal records system. Do not send credentials, client data, or unredacted security evidence with an exploratory inquiry.